

Volodya Shkoda

SENIOR ENGINEERING MANAGER / PLATFORM MODERNIZATION / ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP

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PROFILE

Senior Engineering Manager with a backend engineering background and more than a decade of experience building and modernizing business-critical platforms. Leads a distributed organization of 31 people across five teams responsible for payment processing, subscriptions, product catalog, entitlements, and commerce experiences. Develops engineering leaders, turns around underperforming teams, and translates complex technical constraints into incremental business capabilities.

EXPERIENCE

Semrush | Barcelona, Spain

Senior Engineering Manager, Payment Solution | May 2025 - Present

Lead five cross-functional teams totaling 31 people across backend, frontend, QA, and DevOps, with five engineering leaders as direct reports. Accountable for the organization behind Semrush's payment processing, PCI DSS scope, gateway integrations, subscriptions, product catalog, entitlements, and customer- and admin-facing commerce experiences.

- Built and coached a five-person management layer across a distributed European and Asian organization, delegating stakeholder management, goal setting, and performance reviews while creating capacity for longer-range business and platform planning.
- Turned around a seven-person engineering team within four months, restoring delivery and morale, hiring critical roles, and resolving the root causes of 10-15 disruptive recurring alerts; the team completed all commitments while retiring legacy services and reducing technical debt.
- Generalized the company's core legacy product into a catalog-driven model, reducing a new product-line launch from an estimated quarter of cross-service engineering to catalog configuration while preserving legacy access for existing customers.
- Retired three redundant, undocumented services and consolidated their functionality into clearly owned domains, reducing maintenance overhead and eliminating duplicated implementation paths.
- Anticipated the need for third-party subscription provisioning following a company acquisition and turned a vendor-specific request into a reusable API, first integrating an external sales platform and then extending the same foundation to Adobe.

Technical Owner | March 2023 - May 2025

Owned technical planning, architecture, roadmap, estimates, priorities, and stakeholder communication for a five-person cross-functional team formed to modernize product configuration and entitlement management.

- Conceived and led a staged modernization of product configuration embedded across nearly ten services: code generation first reduced a month-long team effort to a few engineer-days, while the eventual stateful catalog and administrative UI enabled real-time operational changes.
- Incrementally extracted undocumented business rules into a YAML-backed GraphQL catalog, allowing consumer services to remove hardcoded configuration and revealing their actual data dependencies.
- Structured a two-year transformation repeatedly interrupted by urgent business work into independently useful increments, avoiding an all-or-nothing rewrite and preserving delivery momentum.

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SENIOR ENGINEERING MANAGER

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Semrush | Barcelona, Spain

Backend Developer | September 2020 - March 2023

- Designed a shared Amazon API gateway used by four teams and 8-10 tools, centralizing authorization, request signing, token handling, burst protection, and usage analytics.
- Helped decommission an Amazon seller platform by moving its products into Semrush App Center and building a consent-based service that migrated thousands of users and their data to standalone applications.
- Co-owned an internal portal in a two-person team, building Django APIs and administrative interfaces while establishing CI/CD, Kubernetes deployments, Helm packaging, and production logging.

Quantenna Communications | Member of Technical Staff | Saint Petersburg, Russia | April 2019 - September 2020

- Rebuilt an unstable Kafka-to-Cassandra consumer in Go for a Wi-Fi telemetry platform serving approximately five million devices, eliminating recurring crashes and draining the accumulated event backlog.
- Built a Django reservation and queueing system for 20+ shared hardware test environments, replacing chat-based coordination and exposing utilization bottlenecks for capacity planning.
- Independently built an ETL pipeline that converted binary device dumps into Parquet datasets in Amazon S3 for downstream Apache Spark analytics.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Dell EMC | Senior Software Engineer | Saint Petersburg, Russia | January 2017 - April 2019

Developed management APIs and integrated backup capabilities for Dell EMC XtremIO, an enterprise storage platform, using Python, Twisted, PostgreSQL, and pytest.

220 Volt | Python Developer | Saint Petersburg, Russia | August 2016 - December 2016

Re-architected a daily pricing and product-promotion integration between 1C:Enterprise and Yandex Market, replacing in-memory filtering with an indexed PostgreSQL model and parallelizing external requests to reduce processing time from more than 24 hours to 40 minutes.

RAMAX Group | Junior Python Developer | Saint Petersburg, Russia | 2012 - 2013

Developed XLSX import, XML reporting, and web-form functionality for a production logistics system alongside a senior mentor.

EDUCATION

Technische Universität Ilmenau | Master of Science, Electrical Engineering and Information Technology | 2016

Thesis: Development of a Classification System for the Identification of Vehicle Types

Saint Petersburg Electrotechnical University "LETI" | Master's degree, Computer Systems Engineering and Informatics | 2015

Aalto University | Exchange semester through LETI's academic mobility program | 2015

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

Python, Go, Django, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, Cassandra, GraphQL, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Prometheus, Grafana, CI/CD